

RUNNER

Development Workplan

From training logic to launch, adaptive coaching, integrations, and long-term product differentiation

PLAN • EXPLAIN • ADAPT • MOTIVATE

PRODUCT OBJECTIVE	Build an AI running coach that creates credible plans, explains every workout, adapts to real life, and helps runners reach race day prepared.
CORE PROMISE	Tell me what to do today, explain why, and adjust the plan when reality changes.
NORTH STAR	Become the smartest running coach in every runner's pocket.
LAUNCH FOCUS	A small, reliable coaching product - not a social network or GPS clone.

Executive Summary

Runner is not primarily a tracker, social network, or generic chatbot. It is a coaching system built around one repeatable behavior loop: prescribe the right workout, make it understandable, capture what happened, and adapt the remaining plan.

Core Product Loop

1. The runner enters a goal, race date, current fitness, schedule, and preferences.
2. Runner generates a safe, personalized training plan.
3. The runner opens the app and sees today's workout.
4. The runner completes, skips, reschedules, or rates the workout.
5. Runner updates the remaining plan when necessary.
6. The runner sees progress toward race day.
7. The cycle repeats until the race is completed.

Strategic Build Order

8. Training rules
9. Safety rules
10. Plan generator
11. Plan validation
12. Today screen
13. Workout completion
14. Basic adaptation
15. Explanations
16. Progress
17. Notifications
18. Integrations
19. Predictions
20. Premium coaching tools
21. Native tracking
22. Social features

Phase 0 - Product and Coaching Foundation

GOAL Define the training system before building more screens or AI features.

0.1 Define Target Users

- First-time and recreational 5K runners
- Beginner and intermediate 10K runners
- First-time and experienced half-marathon runners
- First-time and intermediate marathon runners
- Returning runners after a break
- Runners with limited weekly availability

For each profile, define current weekly mileage, longest run, frequency, recent performance, target distance and date, goal type, available days, long-run preference, experience, and injury considerations.

0.2 Define Required Onboarding Inputs

- Race distance and race date
- Goal type: finish, finish comfortably, improve fitness, target time, build consistency, or return to running
- Current weekly mileage and longest run
- Available training days, long-run day, and rest-day preferences
- Recent race times and estimated easy pace

- Experience level, age range, injury status, and schedule restrictions
- Cross-training access and measurement units

0.3 Define Plan Eligibility Rules

- Detect insufficient preparation time
- Detect goals or mileage beyond current fitness
- Detect marathon requests that require base building
- Detect unrealistic target times or too few available days
- Flag pain or injury that needs professional evaluation
- Respond by accepting, modifying, redirecting, or declining unsafe goals

0.4 Define Training Plan Structure

- Build, recovery, peak, taper, and race weeks
- Easy, recovery, long, tempo, threshold, interval, hill, and rest sessions
- Optional cross-training, strength, and mobility recommendations

Every workout must include a name, purpose, warm-up, main set, cool-down, target distance or duration, pace or effort, completion criteria, modification options, and safety notes.

0.5 Define Training Safety Rules

- Weekly mileage and long-run progression limits
- Recovery spacing after long and hard sessions
- Maximum hard workouts per week
- Beginner run-walk logic and reduced-load weeks
- Taper and minimum preparation rules
- Return-from-illness and return-after-missed-training rules
- Pain, heat, altitude, fatigue, and last-minute mileage safeguards

0.6 Define Pace and Effort Zones

- Recovery
- Easy
- Steady
- Marathon effort
- Tempo
- Threshold
- Interval
- Repetition
- Sprint

Each zone should provide an RPE range, talk-test description, optional heart-rate guidance, optional pace calculation, and its training purpose.

0.7 Define Adaptation Rules

- Missed easy, long, or speed workout
- Multiple missed workouts
- High fatigue or poor sleep
- Illness, vacation, or schedule change
- Workout too easy or too hard
- Pain reported
- Race date or goal changed
- Training interruption
- Faster-than-expected progress or repeated struggle

Every adaptation must state what changed, why it changed, what triggered it, and whether the runner can undo it.

0.8 Build Plan Validation Tests

- Short and long preparation windows for every race distance
- Three-day and five-day schedules
- Missed consecutive workouts
- Illness and pain scenarios
- Race-date changes and unrealistic goals
- Repeatedly easy or hard workout feedback

DEFINITION OF DONE Training, safety, and adaptation rules are documented; at least 20 representative runner profiles exist; and generated plans pass automated logical checks without relying on AI explanations.

Phase 1 - Core MVP

GOAL Launch a stable product that generates credible plans and guides runners through daily training.

1.1 Account and User Profile

- Account creation and login
- Basic profile, units, time zone, training preferences
- Notification, privacy, and data-deletion settings

1.2 Goal-Based Onboarding

- Explain why each question matters
- Avoid unnecessary questions
- Detect conflicting answers and unrealistic goals
- Allow input review and show a clear plan summary before activation

1.3 Training Plan Generator

- 5K, 10K, half marathon, and marathon
- Beginner, intermediate, and advanced
- Completion and target-time goals
- Flexible plan lengths
- Weekly schedule, daily workouts, progression, recovery weeks, taper, and race week

1.4 Plan Review Screen

- Race goal and date
- Plan length and training days
- Peak volume and longest run
- Hard-workout frequency and long-run day
- Expected weekly time commitment
- Editable training days, rest days, goal, and race date

1.5 Today Screen

- Today's workout, purpose, distance or duration
- Target pace or effort and workout structure
- Warm-up, cool-down, and estimated time
- Complete, reschedule, skip, ask why, or report pain/illness/fatigue

1.6 Workout Detail Screen

- What am I doing?
- How hard should it feel?

- Why am I doing it?
- What if I cannot complete it?
- What mistakes should I avoid?

1.7 Calendar and Weekly Schedule

- Weekly and monthly views
- Workout types and statuses
- Rest days, race day, and current training week

1.8 Manual Workout Logging

- Completed, partial, or skipped
- Duration, distance, pace, heart rate
- Perceived effort and difficulty
- Pain, fatigue, and notes

1.9 Basic Adaptation

- Missed or rescheduled workout
- Workout too hard or too easy
- High fatigue, illness, or pain
- Race-date change

1.10 Workout Feedback

- Completion status and difficulty
- Body feel and pain check
- Short positive feedback
- Any plan adjustment and next-workout preview

1.11 Progress Screen

- Race countdown and current week
- Workout completion percentage
- Planned versus completed distance
- Weekly consistency, longest run, streak, and recent progress

1.12 Notifications

- Today's workout and long-run reminder
- Missed-workout follow-up
- Workout completion and recovery reminder
- Weekly recap and race countdown milestone

1.13 Weekly Recap

- Planned and completed workouts
- Distance, time, and longest run
- Hardest workout and consistency
- Plan changes and next-week preview

1.14 Basic AI Explanations

- Explain workouts and plan changes
- Translate running terminology
- Summarize weekly progress
- Answer questions grounded in the active plan

AI may not independently rewrite training load, diagnose injuries, recommend ignoring pain, make unsupported medical claims, or generate unsafe advice.

DEFINITION OF DONE A runner can complete onboarding, receive a credible plan, understand and log today's workout, receive useful feedback, see progress, and continue for multiple weeks.

Phase 1 Exclusions

- Native GPS
- Social network or public profiles
- Teams, challenges, or virtual races
- Route planning, watch app, or voice coaching
- Coach marketplace
- Advanced predictions or complex badge systems
- Open-ended generic AI chat

Phase 2 - Adaptive Coach

GOAL Make Runner respond intelligently to real life.

2.1 Daily Readiness Check-In

- Sleep quality
- Fatigue and soreness
- Stress and motivation
- Pain and available time
- Keep completion under 30 seconds

2.2 Missed Workout Logic

- Skip easy runs when appropriate
- Move long runs only when recovery remains safe
- Do not place hard sessions together
- Reduce load after multiple misses
- Never blindly stack missed workouts

2.3 Illness Mode

- Report mild illness, moderate illness, fever, respiratory symptoms, or recovery
- Pause, rest, reduce duration, remove intensity, or gradually rebuild

2.4 Pain and Injury Handling

- Capture location, severity, duration, walking impact, and worsening during running
- Continue cautiously, replace, stop, rest, or recommend professional evaluation
- Never diagnose an injury

2.5 Vacation and Schedule Mode

- Mark unavailable dates
- Reduce weekly training
- Move long runs
- Replace runs with cross-training
- Pause and restart

2.6 Dynamic Weekly Schedule

- Move or swap days
- Shorten workouts

- Change availability or frequency
- Protect key sessions and recovery spacing

2.7 Difficulty-Based Adaptation

- Respond to repeated easy or hard ratings
- Detect improving easy pace
- Detect incomplete long runs
- React to sustained fatigue or repeated misses
- Adjust gradually

2.8 Goal Changes

- Change date, distance, goal type, target time, or days available
- Show what changes, what remains, risk level, and new training path

2.9 Consistency Score

- Use completion, key sessions, long runs, schedule consistency, recovery, and recent trend
- Do not punish legitimate illness or injury

2.10 Weekly Coaching Recap

- What went well
- What needs attention
- Why next week looks different
- Which session matters most
- Whether the goal remains realistic

DEFINITION OF DONE The runner can miss workouts, get sick, travel, experience fatigue, or change schedules without making the plan useless.

Phase 3 - Automatic Data Import

GOAL Reduce manual logging and improve coaching accuracy.

3.1 Health Connect

- Import running workouts, distance, duration, pace, heart rate, calories, and elevation where available

3.2 Apple Health

- Build when the iOS version begins

3.3 Strava Import

- Import activities and match them to planned workouts

3.4 Garmin Import

- Import workouts, distance, pace, heart rate, elevation, and permitted training data

3.5 Future Integrations

- Coros, Polar, Suunto, Fitbit, and others only after demand

3.6 Workout Matching

- Match planned and completed workouts
- Detect full, partial, or unrelated activities
- Allow the user to correct every match

DEFINITION OF DONE Most users with connected devices rarely need to enter completed workouts manually.

Phase 4 - Performance Intelligence

GOAL Help runners understand whether training is working.

4.1 Progress Trends

- Weekly mileage and frequency
- Long-run progression
- Easy pace and heart-rate trends
- Completion, intensity distribution, and consistency

4.2 Personal Records

- Fastest 1K, mile, 5K, 10K, half marathon, and marathon
- Longest run and highest weekly mileage

4.3 Pace Prediction

- Current race fitness across standard distances
- Show uncertainty and explain the data used

4.4 Race Prediction

- Use recent workouts, long runs, consistency, pace trends, interruptions, course, and weather
- Never present predictions as guarantees

4.5 Training Load Dashboard

- Recent and long-term load
- Intensity balance and hard-session frequency
- Recovery trend, sudden increases, and fatigue indicators

4.6 Plateau Detection

- No improvement despite consistency
- Excess intensity or insufficient recovery
- Repeated undertraining or missed workouts
- Inappropriate pace targets

4.7 Season Planner

- Primary and secondary races
- Tune-up races
- Base, recovery, and multiple training blocks

4.8 Taper Planner

- Personalize by distance, mileage, experience, fatigue, long-run history, and injury risk

DEFINITION OF DONE Runner can explain whether training is improving performance and whether the user remains on track.

Phase 5 - Premium Coaching Experience

GOAL Support the full race-preparation journey.

5.1 Race Strategy

- Starting, middle, and final-race pacing
- Hill and walk-break strategy
- Negative splits and adjustment triggers

5.2 Weather Recommendations

- Heat, cold, wind, humidity, rain, and altitude

5.3 Fueling Recommendations

- General, non-medical guidance based on duration, intensity, preferences, and prior feedback

5.4 Hydration Recommendations

- Flexible ranges informed by weather, duration, intensity, sweat feedback, and aid stations

5.5 Recovery Planner

- Rest, easy movement, mobility, sleep, reduced training, post-race recovery, and return progression

5.6 What-If Simulator

- Different dates, target times, schedules, missed weeks, training days, or race distances

5.7 Goal Simulator

- Required time and volume
- Estimated difficulty and risk
- Alternative goals and recommended preparation length

DEFINITION OF DONE Runner supports planning, training, tapering, racing, recovery, and the next goal.

Phase 6 - Native Tracking and Device Experience

GOAL Reduce dependence on third-party apps only after the coaching product is proven.

6.1 Native GPS Tracking

- Time, distance, pace, splits, route, elevation, connected heart rate, pauses, and auto-pause

6.2 Live Coaching

- Pace, heart-rate, interval, distance, time, turnaround, and segment-change alerts

6.3 Voice Coaching

- Short, timely, optional, non-repetitive, and customizable prompts

6.4 Watch Support

- Start with the platforms users request most

6.5 Route Planning

- Distance-based, out-and-back, and loop routes
- Elevation and surface preferences
- Saved routes

6.6 Gear Tracking

- Shoes, mileage, retirement threshold, usage history, and notes

6.7 Offline Mode

- View, track, and complete workouts offline, then sync later

6.8 Widgets

- Today's workout, race countdown, weekly progress, and next run

DEFINITION OF DONE Runner can independently deliver, track, and coach a workout without another fitness app.

Phase 7 - AI Coach 2.0

GOAL Create a coach that feels consistent, informed, and trustworthy.

7.1 Long-Term Memory

- Previous races and plans
- Training interruptions and reported injuries
- Preferred days, coaching style, and motivation
- Enjoyed and difficult workouts
- Typical fatigue patterns
- User can view, correct, and delete memories

7.2 Daily Check-Ins

- Ask only brief, relevant questions based on recent training, upcoming key sessions, fatigue, recovery, or misses

7.3 Weekly Coaching Session

- Performance, consistency, fatigue, key learning, next-week objective, and goal status

7.4 Monthly Coaching Report

- Volume, fitness trends, consistency, achievements, risks, projection, and focus

7.5 Personalized Motivation

- Encouraging, direct, calm, data-focused, competitive, or minimal
- Never use guilt, shame, or harassment

7.6 Long-Term Analysis

- Seasonal patterns
- Repeated errors and successful preparation patterns
- Injury-related patterns and plateaus
- Best race distances and weekly structure

DEFINITION OF DONE The AI gives advice that reflects the runner's actual history rather than responding like a new chatbot every time.

Development Workstreams

WORKSTREAM	RESPONSIBILITY
A - Training Engine	Plan generation, training rules, pace calculations, workout selection, progression, recovery, tapering, adaptation, validation, and safety constraints. Highest priority.
B - User Experience	Onboarding, Today screen, calendar, workout detail, logging, progress, adjustments, notifications, accessibility,

C - AI Coach	and simplicity. Explanations, feedback, summaries, plan questions, coaching tone, memory, guardrails, and AI cost control.
D - Data and Integrations	Workout storage, history, Health Connect, Apple Health, Garmin, Strava, matching, permissions, and sync reliability.
E - Quality and Safety	Automated tests, plan validation, edge cases, disclaimers, pain handling, privacy, security, crashes, performance, and deletion.
F - Product Analytics	Activation, completion, retention, adherence, adaptation usage, AI usefulness, conversion, and feature usage.

Immediate Execution Plan

SPRINT	FOCUS	OUTPUT
Sprint 1 - Product Specification	Target profiles; onboarding inputs; goal types; eligibility rules; terminology; workout categories; phases; safety constraints.	Product requirements document, training-engine specification, and initial data model.
Sprint 2 - Training Logic	Weekly mileage, long-run, intensity, recovery, workout selection, taper, beginner, and duration logic.	Deterministic plan-generation engine and test plans for every distance.
Sprint 3 - Validation System	Runner profiles; automated checks; unsafe progression; conflicts; unrealistic goals.	Repeatable test suite and plan quality report.
Sprint 4 - MVP Screens	Onboarding, plan review, Today, workout detail, calendar, logging, progress, profile, and settings.	Fully navigable MVP using real plan data.
Sprint 5 - Completion Loop	Complete, skip, reschedule, rate difficulty, report fatigue or pain, and add notes.	Functional daily coaching loop.
Sprint 6 - Basic Adaptation	Missed-run handling, fatigue reduction, illness pause, pain warning, race-date and schedule changes.	Explainable plan changes with undo capability.
Sprint 7 - AI Explanation Layer	Why this workout, why the plan changed, pace and effort explanations, recap, and post-workout feedback.	Constrained AI grounded in the active plan.
Sprint 8 - Notifications and Analytics	Reminders, follow-ups, recap, countdown, activation, and retention tracking.	Measurable MVP ready for testing.
Sprint 9 - Internal Testing	Every distance and level, edge windows, misses, changes, fatigue, illness, pain, crashes, restarts, data loss, and notifications.	Critical issues resolved and stable end-to-end experience.
Sprint 10 - Closed Beta	Recruit diverse runners; collect plan credibility, clarity, usability, adaptation, AI, notification, and stopping reasons.	Prioritized launch fixes and evidence of user value.
Sprint 11 - Launch Preparation	Store listing, screenshots, policies, support, crash reporting, analytics, feedback, deletion, polish, performance, and final validation.	Public launch candidate.

Priority Classification

Must Have for Launch

- Onboarding
- Safe plan generation
- 5K, 10K, half marathon, and marathon
- Today screen and workout detail
- Calendar and manual logging
- Basic adaptation and workout feedback
- Weekly progress and notifications
- Settings, profile, and plan explanations

Should Have Soon After Launch

- Health Connect
- Better missed-workout logic
- Vacation mode and fatigue check-ins
- Weekly coaching recap
- Personal records and trends
- Pace prediction

Could Have Later

- Fueling and hydration
- Weather
- Season planning and multiple races
- Voice coaching and watch support
- Native GPS and route planning
- Shoe tracking

Do Not Build Without Demand

- Community and teams
- Social feed and public profiles
- Coach marketplace
- Training groups and leaderboards
- Virtual races

Product Metrics

Activation

- Account created
- Onboarding completed
- Plan generated and activated
- First workout viewed and completed

Primary activation metric: Percentage of new users who activate a plan and complete their first prescribed workout.

Early Engagement

- Workouts completed in the first seven days
- Days the app is opened
- Plan questions asked
- Workout feedback submitted

- Plan adjustments accepted

Primary early-engagement metric: Percentage of activated users who complete at least three prescribed workouts during their first seven days.

Retention and Quality

- Week-one, week-four, and week-eight retention
- Percentage still following a plan and reaching race week
- Difficulty ratings, skipped workouts, pain reports, and abandonment
- User-rated plan credibility and AI helpfulness
- Unsafe-response flags and AI cost per active user

Business Metrics - Later

- Trial starts and subscription conversion
- Monthly retention and cancellation reasons
- Revenue per paying user
- AI and infrastructure cost per user

Non-Negotiable Product Rules

23. The training engine controls training load.
24. AI explains and personalizes; it does not invent unsafe plans.
25. Every plan change must be explainable and visible.
26. Users must be able to correct bad data and undo reasonable changes.
27. Pain and illness must never be treated as laziness.
28. Missed workouts must not be blindly stacked.
29. The app should protect recovery.
30. The Today screen must remain simple.
31. Every feature must improve training, understanding, adaptation, or motivation.
32. Native GPS is not a launch requirement.
33. Social features remain secondary.
34. User trust matters more than appearing intelligent.
35. A smaller reliable product is better than a large inconsistent product.

Launch Definition of Done

- A new user completes onboarding without help
- The app generates a logically safe plan
- The runner understands today's workout
- The runner can complete, skip, or move a workout
- The plan responds appropriately to basic disruptions
- Every adjustment includes an explanation
- Progress is visible and notifications are useful
- Training data is not lost and critical flows do not crash
- Sample plans pass validation tests
- Beta users describe Runner as a coach rather than merely a calendar

Backlog

Build only after meaningful user demand. These features must never distract from the coaching product.

- Community
- Teams
- Challenges

- Public profiles
- Social feed
- Virtual races
- Training groups
- Coach marketplace
- Social sharing
- Public roadmap
- Feature voting
- Clubs
- Leaderboards

RUNNER WINS BY BECOMING EXCELLENT AT

PLAN. EXPLAIN. ADAPT. MOTIVATE.